

KWAKU KARIKARI MANU, PMP

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[Portfolio](#) — mkwakukarikari.github.io

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Transportation Planning Intern

Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

Toole Design Group, Atlanta, GA

- Conducted community engagement initiatives to promote multimodal transportation and active mobility adoption.
- Provided one-on-one route planning and guided practice trips to support behavioral shifts toward sustainable transportation.
- Supported public outreach through workshops, community events, and transportation education programs.
- Delivered MyGCO training and demonstrations to promote sustainable transportation behavior.

Research Assistant

Apr 2025 – Aug 2025

Alabama Transportation Institute, University of Alabama

- Conducted research on active mobility, transportation safety, and sustainable transportation systems in the US & Ghana.
- Analyzed transportation and infrastructure data using GIS, Python, and R for statistical modeling and spatial analysis.
- Contributed to peer-reviewed publications, conference papers, and technical reports.
- Collaborated with interdisciplinary teams to develop data-driven, policy-relevant transportation recommendations.

Transportation Planner

Nov 2021 – Aug 2023

Department of Urban Roads, MRT, Accra, Ghana

- Supported the development of long-range transportation strategies through corridor analysis, traffic data evaluation, GIS mapping, and infrastructure needs assessments.
- Integrated pedestrian, bicycle, and multimodal transportation considerations into roadway planning initiatives to improve accessibility and connectivity.
- Participated in stakeholder consultations and public engagement activities to incorporate community perspectives into transportation planning decisions.
- Evaluated traffic routing strategies and network performance to improve urban mobility, accessibility, and transportation system efficiency.
- Developed GIS maps, spatial analyses, and technical documentation to support transportation planning studies, grant applications, and infrastructure funding proposals.

Transportation Planner

Apr 2020 – Dec 2020

ROM Transportation Engineering Limited, Ghana

- Supported the feasibility study for a Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) system in Kumasi.
- Conducted traffic counts and mobility data collection across key urban corridors.
- Produced transport network maps and route analyses to support planning decisions.

Transportation Planning Intern

May 2019 – Aug 2019

Kumasi Metro Transportation Department

- Drafted and assisted with the implementation of traffic management strategies to reduce congestion in Kumasi.
- Assisted with improving pedestrian and non-motorized transport facilities to enhance walkability and safety.
- Led team training on data collection tools and stakeholder engagement techniques.

- Supported grant applications through GIS mapping and technical analysis.

Transportation Planning Intern
Municipal Planning Office, Ghana

May 2018 – Aug 2018

- Analyzed transportation data and produced GIS maps to support planning decisions.
- Conducted traffic counts and field data collection for transportation analysis.

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate in Geography (Urban and Regional Planning Specialization) The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL	Expected May 2027
Master of Science, Geography (Urban and Regional Planning Specialization) The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL	Aug 2025
Master of Project Management Ghana Institute of Management and Public Administration, Accra, Ghana	Dec 2022
PG Diploma in Sustainable Urban Development (Infrastructure and Green Cities) Erasmus University, Rotterdam, Netherlands	Mar 2022
Bachelor of Science, Urban and Regional Planning Hons. Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi, Ghana	Jul 2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

ArcGIS Pro	ArcMap	ArcGIS Online	QGIS	Adobe Creative Suite
R Programming	Python Programming	SPSS	Drone Operation	Microsoft Suite

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant Department of Geography and the Environment, University of Alabama	Aug 2025 – Present
• Conduct spatial and statistical analysis using ArcGIS Pro and R to examine health disparities and spatial accessibility. • Support research projects through data analysis, literature synthesis, and preparation of publication-ready figures and manuscripts.	
Graduate Teaching Assistant Department of Geography and the Environment, University of Alabama	Aug 2023 – Mar 2025
• Assisted instruction for 90+ undergraduate students in physical geography courses. • Assisted with grading, course coordination, and student engagement.	
Teaching and Research Assistant Department of Planning, Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology	Sep 2020 – Sep 2021
• Supported teaching and research in urban and rural planning. • Contributed to transportation research and supervised undergraduate student projects.	

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Appiah-Opoku, S., Manu, K. K., & Sampson, L. E. (2025). *Assessing motorcycle taxis as transport option in African cities: The case of Accra. Journal of African Studies and Development.*
- Manu, K. K., Appiah-Opoku, S., Weber, J., et al. (2025). *Diabetes prevalence and healthcare accessibility in Alabama’s Black Belt region. Journal of Diabetes and Endocrinology.*